

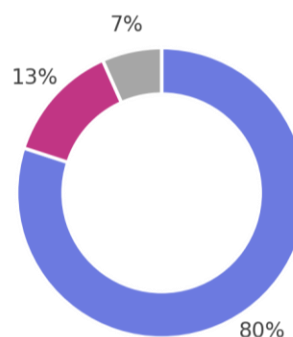
Results from the Board Meeting and Study Trip June 2026 Survey

Responses: 15 (83.3% participation rate)

Part 1: Overall Experience and Impact

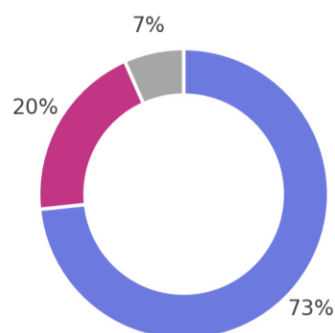
1. Overall, I was satisfied with the study trip.

Strongly Agree	12
Agree	2
Neutral	0
Disagree	0
Strongly Disagree	0
No Answer	1



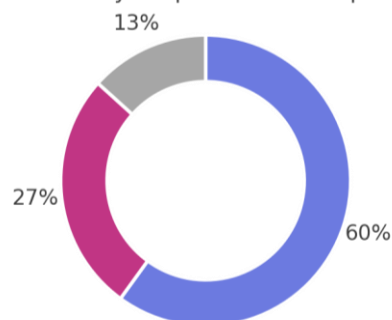
2. Overall, I was satisfied with the board business meeting and discussion sessions.

Strongly Agree	11
Agree	3
Neutral	0
Disagree	0
Strongly Disagree	0
No Answer	1



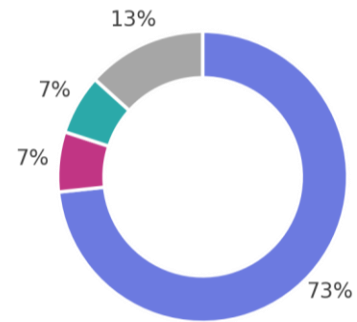
3. The trip helped me understand the on-the-ground impact of United Board programs in the region, including how programs are experienced by institutional leaders and faculty, and how they shape educational practices and outcomes.

Strongly Agree	9
Agree	4
Neutral	0
Disagree	0
Strongly Disagree	0
No Answer	2



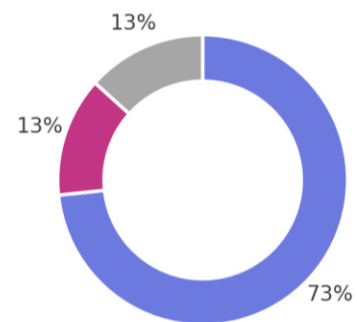
4. The institutions and programs visited helped me better understand the United Board’s portfolio of work in the region.

Strongly Agree	11
Agree	1
Neutral	1
Disagree	0
Strongly Disagree	0
No Answer	2



5. The perspectives shared by local and regional experts were relevant and insightful, and deepened my understanding of the higher education landscape in this context.

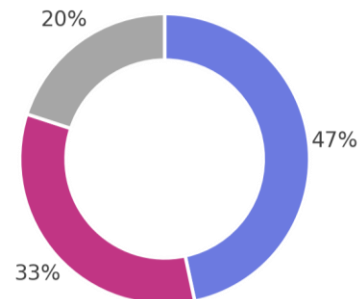
Strongly Agree	11
Agree	2
Neutral	0
Disagree	0
Strongly Disagree	0
No Answer	2



Part 2: Institutional Visits in Chennai

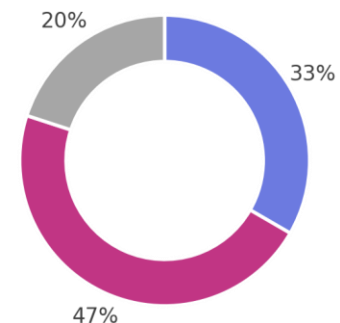
6. The visit to Women’s Christian College provided a valuable opportunity to engage in meaningful discussions with institutional leaders and learn how United Board programs have helped shape their professional and institutional development.

Strongly Agree	7
Agree	5
Neutral	0
Disagree	0
Strongly Disagree	0
No Answer	3



7. The visit to Madras Christian College provided a valuable opportunity to engage in meaningful discussions with institutional leaders and learn how United Board programs have helped shape their professional and institutional development.

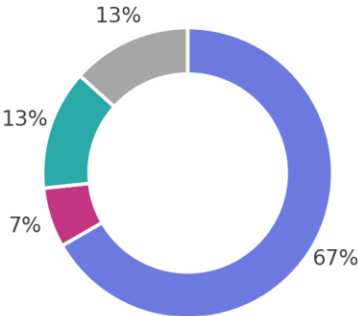
Strongly Agree	5
Agree	7
Neutral	0
Disagree	0
Strongly Disagree	0
No Answer	3



Part 3: Visit to Christ University

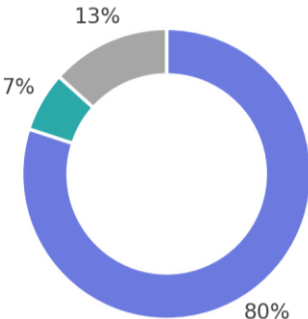
8a. Christ University – Engage in meaningful discussions with institutional leaders, faculty, and program alumni about United Board programs and future needs or opportunities.

Strongly Agree	10
Agree	1
Neutral	2
Disagree	0
Strongly Disagree	0
No Answer	2



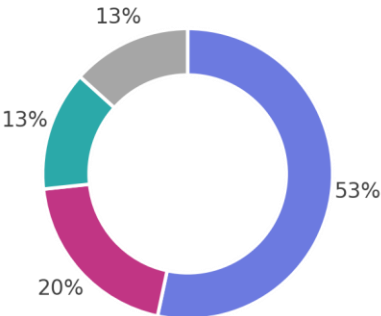
8b. Christ University – Learn about program impact and see how United Board supported initiatives have influenced teaching, learning, institutional development, or student experience.

Strongly Agree	12
Agree	0
Neutral	1
Disagree	0
Strongly Disagree	0
No Answer	2



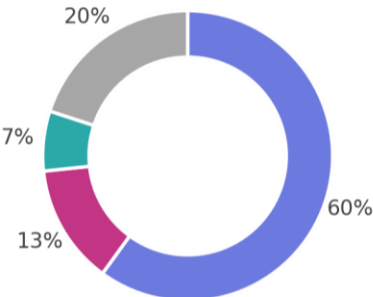
8c. Christ University – Hear direct feedback from participants and program alumni about their experience of United Board programs, including strengths and areas for improvement.

Strongly Agree	8
Agree	3
Neutral	2
Disagree	0
Strongly Disagree	0
No Answer	2



8d. Christ University – Understand the local institutional context, including how Christ University is responding to changes in higher education and what this may mean for the United Board’s work.

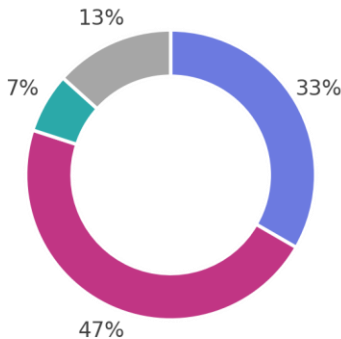
Strongly Agree	9
Agree	2
Neutral	1
Disagree	0
Strongly Disagree	0
No Answer	3



Part 4: Visit to Salesian College

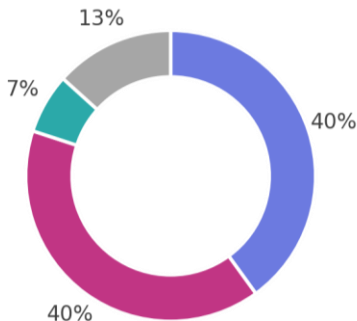
9a. Salesian College – Engage in meaningful discussions with institutional leaders, faculty, and program alumni about United Board programs and future needs or opportunities.

Strongly Agree	5
Agree	7
Neutral	1
Disagree	0
Strongly Disagree	0
No Answer	2



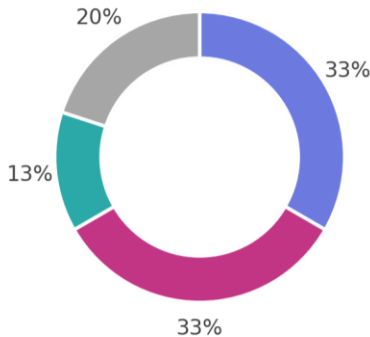
9b. Salesian College – Learn about program impact and see how United Board supported initiatives have influenced teaching, learning, institutional development, or student experience.

Strongly Agree	6
Agree	6
Neutral	1
Disagree	0
Strongly Disagree	0
No Answer	2



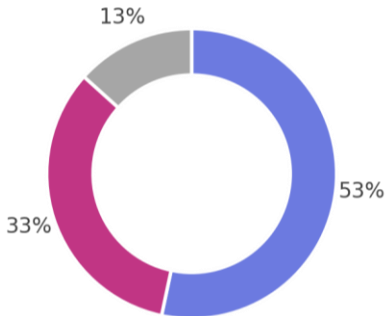
9c. Salesian College – Hear direct feedback from participants and program alumni about their experience of United Board programs, including strengths and areas for improvement.

Strongly Agree	5
Agree	5
Neutral	2
Disagree	0
Strongly Disagree	0
No Answer	3



9d. Salesian College – Understand the local institutional context, including how Salesian College is responding to changes in higher education and what this may mean for the United Board’s work.

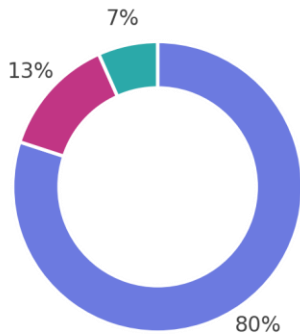
Strongly Agree	8
Agree	5
Neutral	0
Disagree	0
Strongly Disagree	0
No Answer	2



Part 5: Board Materials and Board Meeting

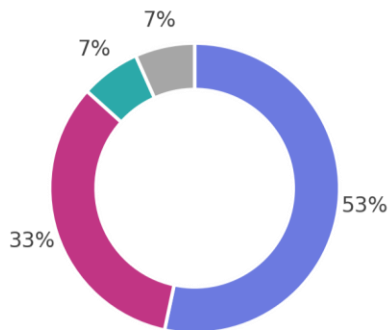
10. The advance materials prepared me well for the board meeting.

Strongly Agree	12
Agree	2
Neutral	1
Disagree	0
Strongly Disagree	0
No Answer	0



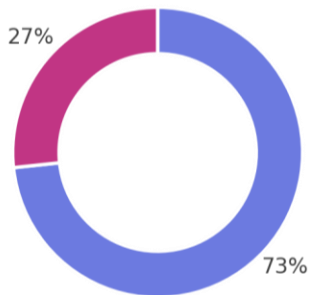
11. The meeting agenda reflected the priorities and strategic direction of the United Board.

Strongly Agree	8
Agree	5
Neutral	1
Disagree	0
Strongly Disagree	0
No Answer	1



12. I was satisfied with the opportunity to participate actively in the discussions.

Strongly Agree	11
Agree	4
Neutral	0
Disagree	0
Strongly Disagree	0
No Answer	0



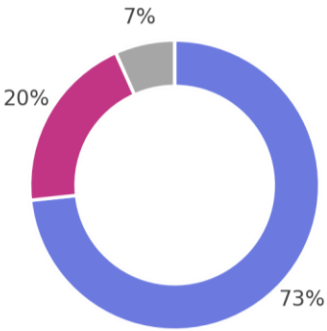
13. I was satisfied with the quality and breadth of contributions from other board members.

Strongly Agree	8
Agree	7
Neutral	0
Disagree	0
Strongly Disagree	0
No Answer	0



14. I was satisfied with the effectiveness of board leadership in facilitating productive and inclusive participation.

Strongly Agree	11
Agree	3
Neutral	0
Disagree	0
Strongly Disagree	0
No Answer	1



Part 6: Open-Ended Reflections

Q15. In what ways were the study trip activities helpful to you as trustee? What is the most significant insight or takeaway from this study trip? (Responses: 13)

- This is the first United Board study trip I have participated in, and having the opportunity to physically experience the network of institutions and understand how the grants have borne fruit is very encouraging. From this trip, the transformative development of Christ University has been particularly enlightening. It has shown me how an institution can be upgraded enormously within a relatively short period when the right investments are provided in a timely manner.
- It helped me appreciate the diversity of approaches to higher education challenges at various Christian institutions.
- The study trip was invaluable in providing an on-the-ground perspective that could not have been gained through reports alone. Visiting the institutions and engaging directly with their leaders, faculty, staff, and students allowed me to see how each institution interprets and implements the Whole Person Education (WPE) framework in ways that reflect its unique mission and context.

For example, I was struck by the distinctive emphasis of each institution. Women's Christian College's strong commitment to developing women leaders is both intentional and transformative, while Salesian College's focus on serving and empowering ethnic communities in Northeast India is deeply inspiring. I was also impressed by the commitment to gender inclusivity demonstrated by both Christ University and Salesian College. These strengths became much more tangible through firsthand observation and conversation than they could have through written reports alone.

My most significant takeaway from the study trip is a deeper appreciation for how a shared vision of Whole Person Education can be expressed in diverse and contextually relevant ways. As a trustee, seeing these institutions in action reinforced the importance of understanding not only outcomes and metrics, but also the local realities, relationships, and institutional cultures that make their work effective and impactful.

- I always find it beneficial to hear from both other trustees and UB staff about issues they feel are important to the future success of the organization.
- Experiencing UB's partner higher education institutions on the ground was very helpful in that it gave me a better idea of how UB support is being used and what UB can do to help Christian higher education in Asia. The opportunity to get to know fellow board members and UB staff better is also much appreciated because it makes board work easier and definitely more pleasant. My most significant takeaway from this trip is that Asian Christian higher education institutions come in all shapes and sizes and therefore UB support and our relationship with institutions will and should reflect these differences. This is something I would like discussed more at the Board level as well with program staff.
- The study trip gave me a greater understanding of the impact of UB's work in the region. The way the partner organizations had taken on the concept of WPE into their curriculum and their programmes was amazing - kudos to the field staff. The onboarding of the Strategic Plan also was impressive for some colleges had started integrating it in their programmes. I greatly valued the fellowship and camaraderie with my fellow trustees and staff.

- The study trip to each site was truly impactful. There is real way to understand the depth and breadth of the impact of UB work until you see it first-hand. I was truly moved. This trip helps board members see how important our work is.
- Witnessing the impact of UB's mission-driven work on the ground, which helped me renew my commitment to UB's work
- insightful to visit funded institutions, see diversity of institutions, depth of UB relationships
- Understanding the local context and pertinent issues that shape the institutions' mission and activities. In particular, learning about constraints and challenges was valuable.
- Being my first Study Trip and Board Meeting, it was a highly enriching experience. It gave me the opportunity to connect meaningfully with fellow Trustees and the United Board staff. The most significant takeaway was gaining a deeper appreciation of United Board's priorities and seeing firsthand the effectiveness and impact of its programmes across partner institutions.
- The context of the work matters. It was extremely important to understand each of the differing contexts of education and UB programming even within one country. I am struck by how even a small financial commitment can bring huge dividends.
- Connection, networking and experience of the impact of the UB grants on the development of the diverse institutions in India

Q16. Are there aspects of the study trip you would suggest modifying in the future, or what could be done to make future study trips more effective for the Board? (Responses: 12)

- While I greatly appreciate the efforts and outcomes delivered by the United Board office and staff in successfully arranging this study trip for trustees to better understand the on-the-ground performance of various programs, I would like to express my sincere thanks to all staff for their hard work and dedication. For future consideration, and based on our discussions during the assessment session, I would suggest incorporating a short consultation session for networked institutions within the same region or country. Such a session could help explore opportunities for domestic (nationwide) cooperation and collaboration. In doing so, these institutions would not only remain recipients of United Board grants, but could also become active partners—working alongside the United Board to advance and transform Christian higher education within their respective countries and across Asia.
- Rather than a single talk (by Dr. Wilson), I think a panel discussion moderated by Pareena or one of the Trustees with several university leaders representing different kinds of institutions might have been more informative.
- While the travel schedule was demanding and some segments—particularly the journey to Darjeeling—were challenging, I would not recommend significant changes to the overall structure of the study trip. The travel itself was an important part of understanding the contexts in which our partner institutions operate, and the experience was well worth the effort. The formal presentations were valuable in providing information and context, but the most meaningful aspects of the trip were the conversations with institutional leaders, faculty, and staff. These interactions offered insights that could not be fully captured in written reports or presentations alone. One enhancement I would suggest for future study trips is to include more structured opportunities for trustees to engage directly with students. Hearing firsthand about their educational experiences, aspirations, and the impact of their institutions would provide an even deeper understanding of the work being supported and its significance in their lives and communities.
- We should attempt to find the right balance of breadth and depth i.e. exposure to a range of institutions and at the same time have the opportunity in at least one institution to interact in greater depth with faculty and students. Also, perhaps our face-to-face board meeting and study tour could include a day set aside for a board retreat. Board retreats are valuable exercises. Rather than scheduling a separate board retreat, perhaps working it into our June face-to-face meeting would be simpler.
- The study trip was extremely useful - although it was a packed programs and tiring at times - I realized the need to have a tight programme in order to get the optimum benefit from the study trip.
- I could say the long trips on the bus but truthfully the bus rides were an opportunity to get to know staff and other board members. Forced learning and engagement. I think it is important to visit two or three sites and hear from participants like we did at WCC. I would have appreciated more time hearing about the impact and maybe an opportunity to hear from students.
- More direct opportunities to witness the work on the ground itself, rather than through the mouth of institutional leaders
- This year's trip felt slightly overscheduled. There should be adequate time for sleep and meals, in the context of local constraints (i.e. traffic, travel) Since the visits cover similar territory -

relationship, length, programs, feels like 4 visits could be sufficient to get the flavor of reach in country - and could then be enhanced with a presentation of overall country impact by staff.

- It would be more useful if we heard from the institutions about future plans and how UB can help with such plans. We heard more about what they were able to accomplish with UB support, but it would have been also very helpful to learn about how UB can improve and better serve their plans for future development.
- One suggestion would be to consider holding the Board Meeting on the first day, followed by the field visits. This could help minimize the impact of travel delays and logistical disruptions, particularly when visiting remote locations. Conducting the Board Meeting in a venue with reliable internet connectivity and appropriate meeting facilities would also enable more focused discussions, after which Trustees could engage more fully in the field visits with a clearer understanding of the context and priorities.
- Perhaps reducing the number of visits might give us enough time for us to take it all in. I would like to figure out how we can see what has NOT worked so well. We tend to showcase the success stories. How about institutions that have not overcome challenges enough to engage with UB offerings.
- The traveling schedules were a bit tight for me which could be considered for the future trip.

Q17. Do you have any host country (two or fewer) recommendations or ideas for our study trip planned for June 2027? (Responses: 11)

- Maybe one of the Northeast Asia countries
- How about both Taiwan and the Philippines (which are in such close proximity)?
- 1) Taiwan for study trip and Board meeting in Chiang Mai. 2) Philippines
- Taiwan; Thailand
- South Korea or Taiwan.
- Taiwan
- Chiang Mai to see the new office, operations, and the collaboration with Payap University Taiwan, where the UB has several historic partner institutions, before it is too late to visit due to growing tensions in the region
- Taiwan, Philippines (seems 2nd to India in partners)
- South Korea if you want to motivate past recipients to share in the vision and fund-raising for UB. Indonesia since you have many (and large in terms of total budget) on-going programs and institutions.
- Thailand, Taiwan
- China, Taiwan or South Korea

Q18. Please share any additional comments, questions, or observations you would like us to consider.
(Responses: 10)

- Although traffic conditions are unpredictable, I would suggest that time management and scheduling arrangements could be further improved.
- In arranging travel for Board meetings, study trips, and other United Board events, consideration should be given to organizational continuity and sound risk management.
- I notice our discussions are always so positive---no disagreements, no critiques, little discussion of what went wrong or what needs to be improved. There is always a lot of praise---for each other and for UB as an organization. Coming from an academic and NGO background where different perspectives and healthy disagreement are the norm and make for lively discussion, I must confess I find this rather unusual and a bit disconcerting. Even in our sessions with our partner institutions, I would have appreciated less of the profuse thanks and more discussion on challenges and suggestions on how else we can support them.
- Greatly appreciate the leadership of Pareena, Su, and the commitment of all the staff. The host team in India with Dr. Spurgeon's leadership should be congratulated!
- It should be a requirement of board generation to attend at least 2 of 3 study trips in each three-year term to be eligible for renewal of term.
- This is the first study tour in its true sense since 2023 and witnessing UB's impact on the ground through collaborative work with network institutions has been transformative. We must require all board members to attend the study tour. If board members cannot, they should consider whether to continue serving on the board. Some US-based board members (mostly white colleagues) need to watch how often they speak and whether they are always the first ones to speak. Let's practice cultural humility with one another.
- Might be worthwhile to start to consider the use of a consent agenda - to allow more time for in-depth conversation at board meetings.
- Local transportation was very difficult and felt unsafe in certain segments of the local transportation. 3-4 hours in heavy traffic, and a short visit was not ideal. More advice for travel caution would have been helpful -- i.e., high altitude so that members could prepare proper medication; air pollution issues, etc.
- The staff worked extremely hard to make the visit smooth and memorable. Thank you!
- Voices from UB webinar/online training participants/alumni could be heard